

De-risked AIDC capex; subleasing visibility key Quick Note

Nvidia's equity investment and Brookfield SPV: Unlocking capital-efficient AIDC growth

Naver has officially disclosed on 27 July a strategic partnership and financing framework to scale its AIDC capacity at GAK Sejong to 200MW by 2028 as part of its 1GW long-term vision. ([link](#)) Under the initial USD10bn investment phase, Nvidia (NVDA US, Not rated) will acquire ~4.5% of Naver common shares for USD1bn. As outlined in Naver's regulatory disclosures, Nvidia's capital payment (due Oct 2026) is contingent upon Naver securing at least USD9bn in external computing infrastructure capital. To satisfy this condition, Naver has selected global infrastructure manager Brookfield (BN US, Not rated) as its exclusive partner under a 12-week negotiation window to establish an off-balance-sheet SPV/project financing framework.

Financial impact: Off-balance-sheet SPV eliminates balance sheet leverage risks

The establishment of the Brookfield SPV directly addresses market concerns regarding Naver's balance sheet leverage and capital intensity, in our view. By placing the underlying real estate, power infrastructure, and Nvidia DSX platform/GPU assets within an off-balance-sheet SPV (where Brookfield holds majority equity), Naver avoids consolidating multi-billion-dollar project debt onto its own balance sheet. Naver will enter into a long-term capacity/lease agreement with the SPV, transforming heavy upfront capex into predictable operating lease payments. ([link](#))

Execution bottlenecks: Success hinges on hyperscale subleasing and shadow debt risks

While the proposed SPV structure mimics the JV between Meta (META US, Not rated) and Blue Owl (OWL US, Not rated) used for mega-scale AIDC campuses, several structural bottlenecks must be resolved for Naver's model to succeed, in our view:

- **End-user demand visibility:** Naver indicated it is nearing contract execution for its initial 200MW capacity with major hyperscaler(s). However, we believe, long-term commercial visibility hinges on securing firm, long-dated subleases across the full 1GW pipeline, particularly given the high fixed lease payments Naver owes the SPV regardless of compute utilization.
- **Capital sourcing for the remaining 800MW:** The current USD10bn framework covers the 200MW phase through 2028. Scaling to 1GW will require ~USD40bn+ in additional capital, requiring Brookfield and other potential PE firms to repeatedly roll over project debt in shifting interest rate environment.
- **Off-balance-sheet accounting and residual value guarantees:** Similar to Meta-Blue Owl, infrastructure sponsors typically demand residual value guarantees or long-term lease commitments to secure low-cost debt. If Naver provides downside guarantees to Brookfield against GPU asset obsolescence, auditing bodies or credit rating agencies may treat these contingent obligations as shadow debt, partially offsetting the balance sheet benefits, in our view.

Rating Remains	Neutral
Target price Remains	KRW 210,000
Closing price 24 July 2026	KRW 207,500

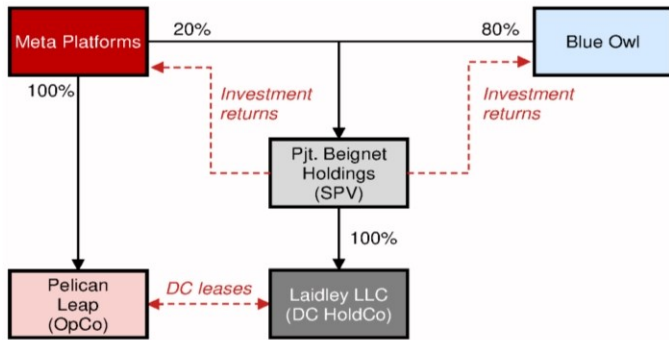
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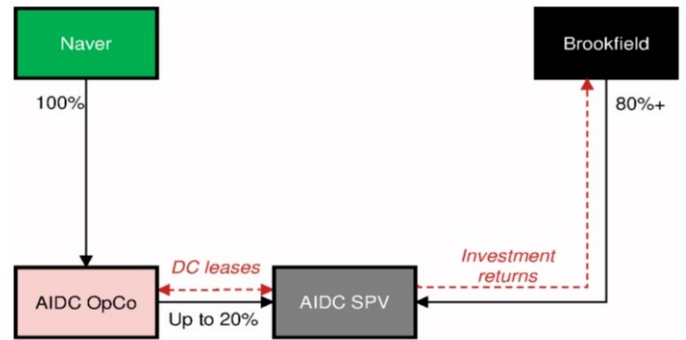
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Fig. 1: Meta — Blue Owl Datacenter JV deal structure

Note: Holding structure simplified
 Source: Company data, Nomura research

Fig. 2: Naver's proposed AIDC investment structure

Note: Holding structure simplified. AIDC SPV ownership not yet finalized between direct holding by Naver or a minority stake through the AI OpCo
 Source: Company data, Nomura research

Appendix A-1

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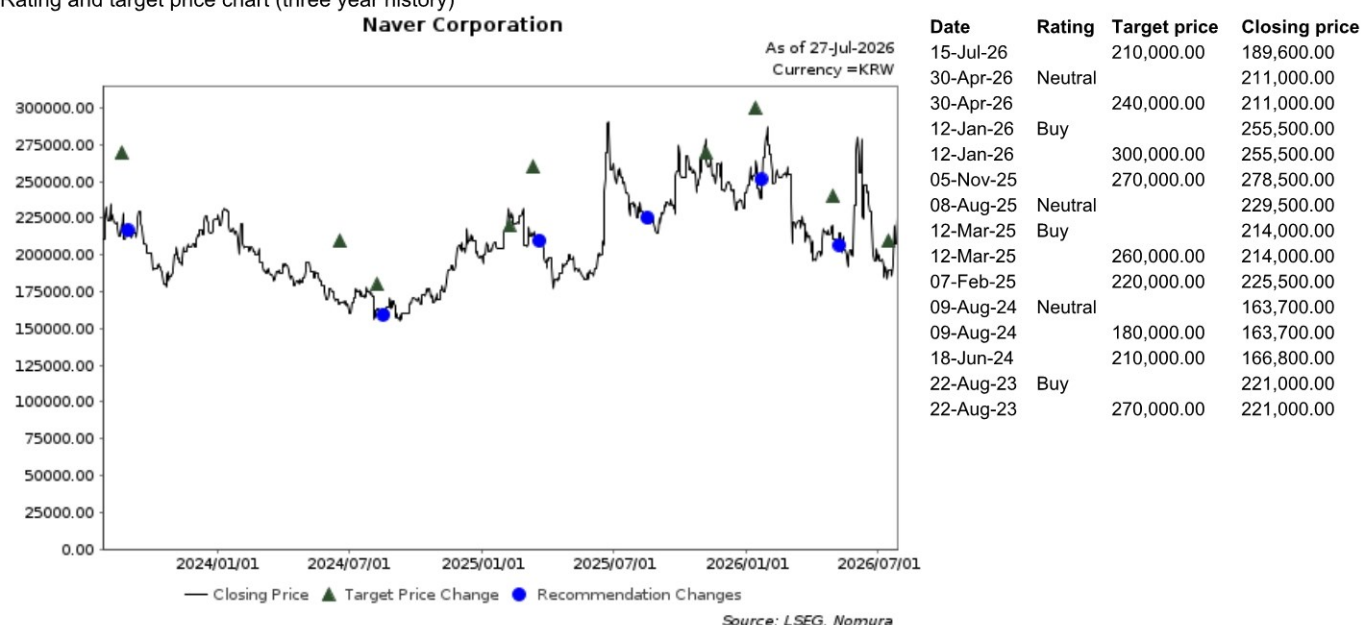
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Issuer	Ticker	Price	Price date	Stock rating	Sector rating	Disclosures
Naver Corporation	035420 KS	KRW 207,500	24-Jul-2026	Neutral	N/A	

Naver Corporation (035420 KS)

KRW 207,500 (24-Jul-2026) Neutral (Sector rating: N/A)

Rating and target price chart (three year history)



For explanation of ratings refer to the stock rating keys located after chart(s)

Valuation Methodology Our target price of KRW210,000 is based on SOTP valuation. The benchmark index for this stock is KOSPI.

Risks that may impede the achievement of the target price Key upside risk is securing of large-scale AIDC contract with hyperscalers and downside risk is AIDC overcapacity.

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